During and After the Flood

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Floods can be scary, but knowing what to do can keep you and your family safe. This module will teach you what to do **when a flood begins**, how to stay safe **during a flood**, and how to help with **recovery efforts** afterward. Being prepared and informed is the best way to protect yourself and your community.

Imagine a calm but alert evacuation. People are helping each other, moving to higher ground in an organized way, with essential items secured. Remember, staying calm and following instructions are key.

During the Flood

If a flood is happening, it's important to act quickly and carefully. Here are some essential safety tips:

- **Stay on Higher Ground:** Move to the highest possible ground, like an upper floor or a roof.
- **Avoid Floodwater:** Floodwater can be dangerous and contaminated. Never walk or swim through it.
- **Turn Off Electricity:** If it's safe to do so, turn off the electricity at the main switch to prevent electric shock.
- **Evacuate Early:** If authorities tell you to evacuate, do so immediately. Don't wait until the last minute.

DO's	DON'Ts
✅ Listen to emergency alerts.	❌ Walk or swim through floodwater.
✅ Move to higher ground.	❌ Touch electrical equipment if wet.
✅ Help others if you can safely do so.	❌ Drink tap water until it’s declared safe.
✅ Stay informed.	❌ Return home until authorities say it’s safe.

Emergency Response

Evacuating safely is crucial during a flood. Here's what you should do:

- **What to Bring:** Pack a bag with essentials like water, non-perishable food, medications, a flashlight, a first-aid kit, and important documents.
- **Assist Others:** If you can, help neighbors, especially the elderly or those with disabilities, to evacuate safely.
- **Contact Authorities:** Call emergency services (like 911) if you need help or see someone in danger.

Imagine an evacuation center – a safe place where people can find shelter, food, and support during the flood. Trained personnel are available to offer assistance and guidance.

After the Flood

Returning home after a flood can be challenging. Follow these steps to stay safe:

- **Clean Up Safely:** Wear protective clothing like gloves and boots when cleaning up. Use disinfectants to kill germs.
- **Check Electrical Systems:** Have a qualified electrician check your electrical systems before turning the power back on.
- **Avoid Waterborne Diseases:** Drink bottled water or boiled water until the tap water is declared safe to drink.

Imagine a step-by-step visual guide, showing people wearing gloves and masks while cleaning, an electrician inspecting wires, and someone boiling water. These visuals emphasize the importance of each safety measure.

Summary & Reflection

Floods can be destructive, but with the right knowledge and preparation, we can stay safe and help our communities recover. Remember the tips you've learned in this module and share them with your friends and family.

Activity: Draw or write about how you can help your community recover after a flood. What actions can you take to make a difference?